

IN THE SENATE

SENATE BILL NO. 1253

BY HEALTH AND WELFARE COMMITTEE

AN ACT

RELATING TO RURAL HEALTH TRANSFORMATION; AMENDING TITLE 56, IDAHO CODE, BY THE ADDITION OF A NEW CHAPTER 25, TITLE 56, IDAHO CODE, TO ESTABLISH THE IDAHO RURAL HEALTH TRANSFORMATION FUND AND TO ESTABLISH THE RURAL HEALTH TRANSFORMATION COMMITTEE; AND DECLARING AN EMERGENCY.

Be It Enacted by the Legislature of the State of Idaho:

SECTION 1. That Title 56, Idaho Code, be, and the same is hereby amended by the addition thereto of a NEW CHAPTER, to be known and designated as Chapter 25, Title 56, Idaho Code, and to read as follows:

CHAPTER 25

IDAHO RURAL HEALTH TRANSFORMATION PROGRAM

56-2501. IDAHO RURAL HEALTH TRANSFORMATION FUND. (1) There is hereby created and established in the state treasury the Idaho rural health transformation fund. The fund shall consist of moneys received by the state of Idaho from the federal rural health transformation program grant and such other moneys that may be provided by legislative appropriation. Moneys in the fund shall be used solely for federally approved rural health transformation program purposes, subject to appropriation by the legislature upon recommendation from the rural health transformation committee as established in section 56-2502, Idaho Code.

(2) The Idaho rural health transformation fund shall be subject to annual public reporting of all receipts and expenditures.

56-2502. RURAL HEALTH TRANSFORMATION COMMITTEE. (1) There is hereby created the rural health transformation committee, hereafter referred to as the committee. The committee shall consist of six (6) members to be appointed as follows: two (2) members of the senate shall be appointed by the president pro tempore of the senate, one (1) of whom shall be cochair of the committee; two (2) members of the house of representatives shall be appointed by the speaker of the house of representatives, one (1) of whom shall be cochair of the committee; and two (2) nonvoting members shall be selected by the governor. At least three (3) of the legislative members shall be appointed from a legislative district without a population center of twenty thousand (20,000) or more persons. The term of a legislative member of the committee shall coincide with the term of election to the legislature. A vacancy during the term of a member of the committee shall be filled by the appointing authority of that member, and members may be reappointed to a subsequent term.

(2) The committee shall have the following powers and duties:

(a) To establish rules for governance and operation of committee proceedings;

1 (b) To establish any additional requirements for funding subawards,
2 which shall include application scoring rubrics, no later than March
3 15, 2026, for the first award year and by September 30 for the four (4)
4 remaining award years;

5 (c) To establish an expedited award review process with the department
6 of health and welfare for funding subawards. The award review process
7 shall align with federally approved timelines as outlined in Idaho's
8 rural health transformation plan;

9 (d) To receive no less than quarterly updates on progress toward funded
10 projects, expenditures, and outcomes from the department of health and
11 welfare;

12 (e) To evaluate the potential and actual success of programs funded
13 with moneys from the Idaho rural health transformation fund;

14 (f) To retain oversight of moneys in the Idaho rural health transforma-
15 tion fund;

16 (g) To require a sustainability plan for any initiative funded by Idaho
17 rural health transformation moneys; and

18 (h) To make any recommendations to the legislature on the use of funds,
19 as long as recommendations are within the parameters of the federally
20 approved Idaho plan.

21 (3) The committee shall remain active until all moneys in the Idaho ru-
22 ral transformation fund have been appropriated and expended.

23 SECTION 2. An emergency existing therefor, which emergency is hereby
24 declared to exist, this act shall be in full force and effect on and after its
25 passage and approval.